



Selling on Facebook Marketplace — How-To Guide

Quality Firewood & Materials | July 9, 2026

This guide answers the question we started with — "do we sell from the personal Facebook or the business page?" — and then walks through every step of posting, managing, and safely closing the container sales. It pairs with the Listing Pack, which contains the ready-to-paste title, price, description, and photo order for each of the four containers.

1. The Short Answer: Personal Profile Lists, Business Page Shares

Facebook Marketplace listings for items like these can only be created from a PERSONAL Facebook account. A business page has no "create listing" button — that is not a setting to find, it simply does not exist. Facebook's own commerce policy describes Marketplace as "intended for consumer-to-consumer sales."

Businesses used to have two side doors onto Marketplace, and both are gone — which is why so much advice on the internet is out of date:

- **Vehicle & real-estate page listings — discontinued.** Car dealers and realtors could once list vehicles and properties from business pages. Facebook ended that in January 2023.
- **Facebook Shops on Marketplace — discontinued.** Products from a Facebook Shop with on-platform checkout could once appear on Marketplace. Facebook shut down its checkout system in September 2025, closing that route too. (A Facebook Shop today is just a storefront that links out to a company website — useless for selling four used containers.)

So the play is:

The owner posts the four listings from his personal Facebook account, then shares each listing to the Quality Firewood & Materials page (a built-in option — Section 6). The page gets the visibility; the listing itself lives on the personal account, and buyer messages arrive in the personal Messenger.

One planning note: whoever's personal account posts the listings is who receives every buyer message. If the office manager posts them instead of the owner, the "Is this still available?" traffic goes to the office manager's Messenger. Pick the account whose phone should ring.

2. How the Pieces Fit: Personal Account, Page, Business Suite

- **Personal account** — The login and the keys. It is also the only identity that can create Marketplace listings.
- **Business page** — The public storefront identity. You "switch into" the page to post as the business: tap your profile photo, choose "See all profiles," and pick the page. Pages post content and run ads; they do not list on Marketplace.
- **Meta Business Suite** — A free dashboard at business.facebook.com (and a mobile app) for running the PAGE: writing and scheduling posts, answering page messages and comments in one inbox, viewing reach numbers, and buying ads. It has no Marketplace function at all — do not go looking for one there.



Mental model:

The personal account and the business page are two hats on one head. Marketplace only works while wearing the personal hat; Business Suite is the toolbox for the business hat.

3. Before Posting — a 10-Minute Checklist

1. Use an established personal account. Facebook denies or throttles Marketplace access for brand-new accounts (its help pages say so explicitly). A years-old active account sails through.
2. Join the local buy/sell groups FIRST — Las Cruces yard sale groups, Dona Ana County classifieds, farm & ranch and construction-equipment groups, El Paso buy/sell. When you publish a listing, Facebook offers to cross-post it into groups you already belong to; joining beforehand makes that a one-tap step.
3. Get the photos onto the device you will post from. The Listing Pack lists which photos belong to which container and the upload order.
4. Take one extra photo per container: doors standing OPEN. It is the strongest trust photo a container listing can have, and only one unit currently has one.
5. Decide the delivery answer. Every serious buyer asks. "Buyer arranges transport" is fine; "we can deliver within 30 miles for a fee" sells containers.

4. Posting a Listing from the Phone

1. Open the Facebook app and tap the Marketplace icon (the little storefront).
2. Tap "Sell" (top of the screen), then "Items."
3. Tap "Add photos" and select the photos for ONE container, in the order given in the Listing Pack. Up to 10 photos per listing (commonly reported limit); the FIRST photo becomes the thumbnail buyers see in search, so lead with the long side shot.
4. Type the Title exactly as written in the Listing Pack.
5. Price: 3200.
6. Category: type or pick something like "Garden & Outdoor" — Facebook has no shipping-container category; use the closest suggestion it offers.
7. Condition: the Listing Pack gives the value per unit (Used - Good for the blue containers, Used - Fair for the red ones). Honest grading here prevents arguments at the yard later.
8. Description: paste the full description block from the Listing Pack. This is where the size, condition, and "four available" language lives.
9. Location: confirm it shows Las Cruces. Buyers browsing nearby set their own search radius — you do not control how far the listing travels, but a correct location pin puts it in front of Las Cruces and El Paso buyers.



10. Tap Next. If Facebook shows a list of your groups with checkboxes ("List in more places"), check the relevant local ones. Tap Publish.

A first listing can sit in automated review for a short while before it goes live — normal, not a rejection. Then repeat for the next container. Recommended sequence: the two blue units first, the two red units a day or two later — identical listings posted rapid-fire can trip Facebook's duplicate detector, and the pack's per-unit wording plus staggered timing avoids that.

5. Posting from a Computer (Same Thing, Bigger Screen)

1. Go to facebook.com, log in to the personal account, and click "Marketplace" in the left-hand menu.
2. Click "Create new listing," then "Item for sale."
3. Click "Add photos" and upload from the computer. (The container photos are in the project folder — they can be copied to a USB stick or emailed over.)
4. Fill in the same fields as the phone flow — title, price, category, condition, description, location — from the Listing Pack.
5. Click Next, then Publish. If Next is grayed out, a required field is still empty.

6. Right After Posting: Put the Business Page to Work

Sharing each listing to the business page is a built-in, officially supported feature — this is how the page participates:

1. Open the live listing.
2. Tap/click the Share button.
3. Choose "Share to a Page."
4. Pick the Quality Firewood & Materials page, add a line of text if desired ("Clearing four 40-ft containers from the yard — first come, first served"), and post.

The page post links back to the Marketplace listing. Buyer messages still arrive in the personal Messenger, not the page inbox. The same Share menu also offers "Share to a group" for any local groups that were not offered at publish time.

7. Managing the Listings Day to Day

- **One dashboard.** Marketplace > "Your listings" shows everything, with Edit, Mark as pending, Mark as sold, Delete, and Boost on each listing's menu.
- **Price drops work.** Editing the price downward re-surfaces the listing in search and notifies people who saved it. This is the main lever if a unit sits.
- **Renew is free.** A "Renew" option appears on older listings (commonly reported: after about a week) — it bumps the listing back to the top of search results for free. Renew weekly until sold; listings fade out of search after roughly 30 days otherwise.



- **Pending, then sold.** When a buyer commits, "Mark as pending" holds the listing without killing it; "Mark as sold" closes it out. Mark sold promptly — it stops the message flood.

8. Boosting — Optional, and It Costs Money

A boost turns a listing into a paid ad shown in feeds and search beyond organic reach. From "Your listings," choose Boost listing, set a budget and duration, and pay through the account's ad billing. The commonly reported minimum is about \$5/day, and local boosts default to roughly a 40-mile radius. Sensible approach here: post organically first — free — and only consider a modest boost (\$20-\$40 over a few days) on whichever units are still sitting after the first week or two. On \$12,800 of inventory that is proportionate; anything bigger is not.

9. The Rules That Matter for This Sale

- **Containers are allowed.** Shipping containers hit none of Facebook's 24 prohibited commerce categories. Keep the descriptions honest, use photos of the actual units (both already true in the Listing Pack), and make sure the containers are empty.
- **Facebook never touches the payment.** For local pickup sales, Facebook is not involved in the money at all — no fees, and also no protection or mediation for either side. Payment happens between buyer and seller like any yard transaction. That is the normal, intended way to do this.
- **No shipping. Ever.** Facebook's buyer Purchase Protection only exists for items paid and shipped through Facebook checkout. A container is a local-pickup item, full stop — decline every request to "ship" one (Section 10 explains why those requests are always scams).

10. The Scams a \$3,200 Listing WILL Attract

Big-ticket local listings draw a predictable cast of characters. None of these are rare — expect several in the first 48 hours:

- **"Is this still available?" bots.** A flood of instant, generic messages fishing for a phone number or email. Real buyers ask about the container (height? doors? delivery?). Anyone who will not discuss the actual item gets ignored.
- **Fake payment screenshots.** The "buyer" sends a doctored Zelle/Venmo/PayPal "payment sent" image and pressures for release. A screenshot is not money. Only the yard's own banking app showing the funds POSTED counts.
- **The Zelle "business upgrade."** A spoofed email claims the buyer paid from a "business account" and the seller must pay a fee to "upgrade" and receive it — the buyer sweetly offers to cover the fee if reimbursed. No money was ever sent. Zelle has no business upgrade fee.
- **Overpayment refund.** Buyer "accidentally" overpays by check or reversible transfer and asks for the difference back. The original payment later bounces. Never refund an overpayment — cancel the deal instead.
- **The verification-code trick.** A "buyer" asks you to read back a code texted to your phone "to verify you're a real person." That code is them hijacking a phone number or account. No legitimate buyer ever needs a code. Never read one back to anyone.



- **Shipping bait.** Anyone who wants to buy a 4-ton steel box sight-unseen and send "their courier" with a prepaid label is running a scam. Containers sell to people who show up and look inside.

11. Closing Safely: the Yard Advantage

Most Marketplace safety advice is about meeting strangers in parking lots. This sale skips all of that — the yard is the meetup spot, and that is a real advantage:

1. All showings and payment at the yard, during business hours, staff present.
2. Acceptable payment: cash, counted on the spot; or Zelle/bank transfer confirmed as POSTED in the yard's own banking app before the buyer leaves with anything; or a cashier's check verified by calling the issuing bank (find the bank's number yourself — not the number printed on the check).
3. A one-page bill of sale per unit — sold as-is, where-is, with the container ID number, price, date, and both signatures. It takes two minutes and ends any later dispute before it starts.
4. The container leaves the yard only after funds are verified. No exceptions, including for the friendliest buyer with the best story — especially for that one.

12. What Facebook Publishes vs. What Is Commonly Reported

Everything in this guide about WHO can list (personal accounts), HOW to list, sharing to a page, allowed items, and purchase protection comes from Facebook's own help pages and commerce policies. A few operational numbers — the 10-photo limit, the weekly renew cadence, the ~30-day listing life, and boost minimums — are not published by Facebook and come from current seller guides; treat them as reliable rules of thumb, and believe whatever the app itself shows if it differs.